

---

# TV tonight: Cecil the lion who was killed by a trophy hunter

Published by

Phil Harrison, Hannah J Davies, Graeme Virtue, Jack Seale, Ellen E Jones

Estimated reading time

1 min

Added on

2026-02-19

Address

<https://www.theguardian.com/tv-and-radio/2026/feb/19/tv-tonight-cecil-the-lion-who-was-killed-by-a-trophy-hunter>

---

# TV tonight: Cecil the lion who was killed by a trophy hunter

## Cecil: The Lion and the Dentist

**10pm, Channel 4**

There was worldwide outrage after the 2015 shooting of a Zimbabwean lion, Cecil, by an American trophy hunter, Walter Palmer. This documentary approaches the story from several angles. There's the story of the pile-on – Palmer became a pariah in the aftermath of his grim holiday. But there's also a potted history of Hwange national park where Cecil lived, its role in the local economy and the vexed question of the value of nature (spiritual and financial) to the community. *Phil Harrison*

## George Clarke's Building Home

**8pm, Channel 4**

"I'd have rather gone to the Maldives ... " So says Sophie, whose renovation soars over budget. As is the case in Clarke's gentle property series, there's more to it: Sophie is driven by a desire to bring her grandparents' former home back to life – and to bag her very own pink kitchen island. *Hannah J Davies*

## Grantchester

**9pm, ITV1**

---

A timely, if moderately shark-jumpy, season finale of the detective drama helmed by Robson Green and a revolving door of vicars. Fascist Wilbur Church is attacked during a visit to the University of Cambridge, leading a student to plead her innocence ("I couldn't make a bomb – I can barely boil an egg!") *HJD*

## **Murder Trial: The Suffolk Strangler**

### **9pm, Channel 5**

Steve Wright, already serving a whole life sentence for killing five Ipswich women in 2006, was recently back in the news after pleading guilty to the 1999 murder of 17-year-old Victoria Hall. This film re-examines the 2008 court case where the ex-merchant seaman dubbed "the Suffolk Strangler" claimed to be innocent. *Graeme Virtue*

## **Hunting Outback Gold**

### **9pm, U&Yesterday**

In 1931, prospector Harold Lasseter died trying to find a stash of gold he insisted was buried in the central Australian outback. Can two cheery blokes called Jeff and Brendan now fulfil their childhood dream of proving Lasseter right? Episode one of this new series features some exciting metal-detecting. *Jack Seale*

## **Random Acts: 1763**

### **12.05am, Channel 4**

The Random Acts strand has long been the place to discover new film- and TV-making talent; an anything-goes showcase for experimental, short-form visionaries. The latest edition is Nicola Stead's look at what happens after a woman flees domestic violence, with a focus on how Greater Manchester police have handled abuse cases. *Ellen E Jones*

---

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

Please open [an issue](#) if you have trouble with the display of this E-Book on your device.